Begum Rokeya University, Rangpur • Department of Management Information Systems

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring

A Study on RDRS Bangladesh

Submitted By / Submitted To / Host

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In collaboration with **RDRS Bangladesh, Evaluation (MEL) Department**

Fieldwork: Rangpur • Sept 2026

MEL · MIS · G Banker

Date of Submission: _____ Place: Rangpur / Dhaka

Sources: Sept 2026 monitoring schedule • G Banker outputs • Somriddhi May 2023 report

Letter of Transmittal

[Date]

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Subject: Submission of Internship Report on "Evaluating MIS Practices in Project Monitoring: A Study on RDRS Bangladesh"

Dear Sir,

I am pleased to submit my internship report, prepared as a partial requirement for the BBA program, based on my internship at the Evaluation Department of RDRS Bangladesh. The report examines the MIS practices used in project monitoring, drawing on direct observation, discussions with staff, and review of ongoing projects during the internship period.

I tried to keep the report within the scope of my access and the time available, and I would be grateful for your guidance on further revisions. Thank you for your continuous support and supervision.

Sincerely,
A. R. Mahmud ID: 12022065
BBA, Major in MIS

Acknowledgement

I thank my academic supervisor for guidance on structure and scope, and the RDRS Evaluation (MEL) Department staff who gave their time: Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul) for a long walkthrough of baseline design, Fahmida Mostafa for explaining projects and reporting flow, and Mr. Iftekharul Islam for tracing the microfinance MIS history. Any errors in interpretation are mine.

Executive Summary

Guiding question: how does monitoring data actually move from the field to a management decision at RDRS Bangladesh, and where does the system help or break?

I spent the internship inside the MEL function. For routine work the department runs on structured Excel formats and registers; for one-off needs it uses KoBo Toolbox on mobile with direct Excel export; in office it compiles in Excel and builds some dashboards in Power BI. A monthly monitoring schedule turns this into named assignments. The September 2026 schedule I reviewed splits into ten repeat microfinance tasks (each branch visited twice) and project-specific development tasks, including the live ICPS baseline (UNICEF, 06–24 Sept, by Saiful Alam Sekul and Fahmida Mostafa).

Two findings stand out. First, microfinance reporting has moved from a person-dependent process (Micro Bank, 1995–97) through South Tech (2011) to G Banker (2017/18), where branch reports such as the CO-wise Changes Report, POMIS-5 and POMIS-4 now come out with one click into an integrated dashboard. That succession is the report's core continuity lesson. Second, programme monitoring still shows a data-integrity gap: in the May 2023 Somriddhi report, MIS attendance read 100% against 89% in the register, 65% of rehabilitation income records could not be found, and similar MIS-vs-field mismatches recur. Teacher turnover (11 of 74 centres in four months), low tree survival (35% vs. 49%), and patchy follow-up sit alongside real gains in housing conditions.

Recommendations: (1) add a register-to-MIS reconciliation check to the monthly schedule before reports are locked; (2) keep KoBo as the single capture point for ad-hoc surveys so Excel is compilation-only, not re-entry.

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Abbreviations: MEL – Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning; MEAL – plus Accountability; ESS – Environmental and Social Safeguard; TOR – Terms of Reference; FGD – Focus Group Discussion; KII – Key Informant Interview; HH – Household; IGA – Income Generating Activity; CSA – Climate Smart Agriculture; HCVI – Household Climate Vulnerability Index (EI – Exposure Index; SI – Sensitivity Index; ACI – Adaptive Capacity Index); NCD – Non-Communicable Disease; SPSS – Statistical Package for the Social Sciences; PKSF – Palli Karma-Sahayak Foundation; CO – Credit Organizer; OTR – On-Time Repayment; PAR – Portfolio at Risk; DQA – Data Quality Assessment; ATM – Assistant Thana Manager (historic); MSDS – Monthly Savings Deposit Scheme; WASH – Water, Sanitation and Hygiene; LRL – Livelihood Restoration Loan; BFIU – Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

Internship reports matter for BBA/MIS students because classroom models of systems rarely survive contact with registers, branch visits, and monthly deadlines. I interned with the Evaluation Department of RDRS Bangladesh to see how a large NGO actually tracks project progress: who reports, on which form or app, who checks it, and where it is stored.

1.2 Objectives of the Study

Broad objective. To evaluate the MIS practices used in project monitoring at RDRS Bangladesh.

Specific objectives.

1. To identify the MIS tools and systems used by the Evaluation Department.
2. To examine how monitoring data flows from the field to decision-making.
3. To assess strengths and gaps in current MIS practices.
4. To recommend improvements based on findings.

1.3 Scope of the Study

The report covers the Evaluation (MEL) Department during the internship period and the projects I had access to: Jononni, SEEDS, MCGL, ICPS, the microfinance programme,

and the Somriddhi monitoring report. It does not cover the full RDRS portfolio or audited financials.

1.4 Methodology

1.4.1 Sources of data

Primary data came from four interviews and direct observation. I spoke with Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul), now on the ICPS baseline team and formerly Technical Specialist, MEAL and GIS on the BHA project with Save the Children in Sylhet, for close to two hours on MEL work and baseline design. I spoke with Fahmida Mostafa, Senior MEL Officer, on active projects, MEL workflow, programme areas and field scale. I spoke with Mr. Iftekharul Islam, Manager, Monitoring, on how microfinance MIS changed from manual work to the current system. I additionally conducted a key informant interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL), on the C-RANGPUR baseline instrument, indicator measurement, and the KoBo-to-dashboard data pipeline (see Table 1.1; interview date to be inserted from field notes).

Secondary data came from handwritten notes and the supporting documents I reviewed: the MEL Department September 2026 monitoring schedule, sample MIS outputs from G Banker (CO-wise Changes Report, POMIS-5, POMIS-4), the Strategic Plan 2023–2027, the May 2023 field monitoring report on the Somriddhi Programme funded by PKSF, and, for C-RANGPUR, the baseline household questionnaire for indicator result measurement (MEL Department), the project monitoring matrix file F01-112 (“Monitoring Planning” tab), and undated internal planning-meeting notes on the MEL matrix and baseline design.

1.4.2 Data collection method

I collected data through informal interviews, sitting in on explanations of forms and dashboards, and reviewing registers, schedules and reports. A field visit including an eye clinic is planned as direct observation of MEL data collection. The C-RANGPUR key informant interview used a short structured set of MIS questions (automation of the vulnerability calculation, purpose of the code column, submission-to-dashboard flow, baseline-to-target comparison, and separation from the microfinance MIS), with answers recorded as sum-

marised in Chapter 4. Broader discussion in that interview on research methodology is noted separately and kept out of the MIS findings.

Table 1.1. Interviews conducted

Name	Role	Focus
Md. Saiful Alam (Shekul)	ICPS baseline team; ex-MEAL & GIS, BHA/Save the Children	MEL functions; baseline design; indicators, ESS, TOR, Inception Report (~2 hrs)
Fahmida Mostafa	Senior MEL Officer	Active projects; MEL workflow; five programme areas; field scale
Mr. Iftekharul Islam	Manager, Monitoring	Microfinance MIS history: manual to automated
Md. Ajazul Haque	Manager (MEL)	C-RANGPUR MIS pipeline; KoBo instrument; indicator and HCVI measurement (KII; date to confirm)

1.5 Limitations of the Study

Time was short, access to some branch-level data was restricted, and the scope is a single department. Figures move year to year, so I cite the source and date for each number.

CHAPTER 2

Organizational Overview

2.1 About RDRS Bangladesh

RDRS started in Rangpur in February 1972 as the Bangladesh field programme of the Lutheran World Federation (Department for World Service, Geneva). The first job was relief for war-affected people in the northwest: food, shelter, medical help, seeds and tools. The name moved from Rangpur Dinajpur Relief Service to Rangpur Dinajpur Rural Service; it is now RDRS Bangladesh.

The northwest was chosen deliberately: structural isolation, the seasonal hunger gap known locally as Monga, and flood and river erosion from the Teesta–Jamuna–Brahmaputra system. Work shifted in stages: emergency relief (1972–75); schools, health posts, farm advice and village groups (1976–89); handover to Bangladeshi leadership with Trust Act registration and its own Board in 1997; then livelihoods, microfinance, climate adaptation and Union Federations from 1998. RDRS marked 50 years in February 2022. Head Office is House 43, Road 10, Sector 6, Uttara, Dhaka 1230; Central Coordination Office is in Rangpur.

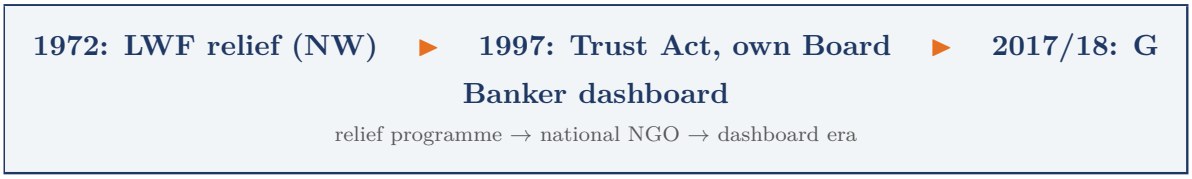


Figure 2.1. RDRS in three dates: from relief programme to national NGO to dashboard-era MIS.

2.2 Mission, Vision and Objectives

Vision (2021–22 annual report): A just and peaceful society where citizens live in dignity, free from poverty, distress, and ignorance in a sustainable environment.

Mission: RDRS works with disadvantaged and marginalized communities and their organizations to empower them, make them resilient, and ensure sustainable improvements in their lives with dignity. In practice this means rural poor households, especially women, higher incomes, stronger capacity against flood and drought, and community groups that continue without constant NGO support.

Core values (current): Compassion, Commitment, Innovation, Adaptability, Accountability. Staff still use older field words (social justice, gender equity, clean accounts), but I quote the five official ones. For monitoring this means every project must show who it reached and what changed — income, resilience, whether the local group can carry on. That is why registers, federation minutes and branch reports matter in Chapter 4.

2.3 Field Scale

Scale shared by MEL (Fahmida Mostafa)

406	33	183	872	~1.64m
Federations	Districts	Upazilas	Unions	People (16,42,724)

Most work is in Rangpur Division (Kurigram, Gaibandha, Thakurgaon, Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Panchagarh, Rangpur, Lalmonirhat), plus Ukhiya/Teknaf in Cox's Bazar and smaller work in Sylhet, Mymensingh and Rajshahi.

For reference, the 2021–22 annual report cited 7 divisions, 30 districts, 165 upazilas, 1,230 unions and 1,488,071 participants; the Dec 2024 microfinance sheet lists 29 districts, 288 branches, 21,134 groups, 458,819 members and 377,250 borrowers (savings BDT 5.14bn, outstanding BDT 15.09bn, recovery 95.08%).

2.4 Organizational Structure

A Board of Trustees governs RDRS with a General Body and senior management. Foreign-funded projects need NGO Affairs Bureau clearance (Foreign Donations Regulation Act 2016, FD6 forms, annual audited accounts). Lending falls under the Microcredit Regulatory Authority. Field work runs through regions, areas and branches (roughly 16–17 regions, 59–61 areas, 278–288 branches). The Evaluation Department cuts across all of it on monitoring and data. Union Federations are community-owned at Union Parishad level (406 federations; safety-net claims, dispute settlement, standing-committee seats).

2.5 The Evaluation Department

I was attached to the Evaluation Department. Field reports arrive here from groups, federations and branches; staff check, compile and send findings to management. What I tracked was simple: who reported, when, on which form or app, who checked it, where it is stored. A late report or vague indicator in the field becomes a gap in the monthly sheet. Chapter 4 follows that flow; notes here stay observational.

2.6 Overview of Ongoing Projects

RDRS groups work into five areas: (1) Skills, Employment and Entrepreneurship; (2) Social Empowerment; (3) Agriculture, Food Security and Climate Change; (4) Microfinance and Employment Creation; (5) Emergency and Humanitarian Response. Monitoring Officers cover all five.

The C-RANGPUR project (Climate Resilience And Nurturing Growth for Poverty Upliftment in Rangpur) sits in the agriculture, food security and climate change area and is handled by the MEL Department. Its stated Objective 1, as recorded in the monitoring matrix, is that the resilience of climate-affected households among the target group has been improved. The September 2026 monitoring schedule lists its baseline across Rangpur, Lalmonirhat, Kurigram, Sirajganj, Gaibandha and Jamalpur. The instrument, indicators and vulnerability methodology behind that baseline are examined in Chapter 4.

Table 2.1. Projects that came up repeatedly in interviews

Project	What it does	Donor / period
Jononni	Maternal/neonatal health; pregnant women	Save the Children, Mar 2023–Dec 2027 (Sept 2026 schedule)
SEEDS	Schooling for adolescents in adibashi communities; 3,000 families	Stromme Foundation, Jan 2024–Dec 2028
MCGL	Fewer preventable deaths; maternal/newborn/child health	U.S. Dept. of State via Jhpiego
ICPS	Disability-inclusive child protection (see Sec. 4.1.2)	UNICEF, Jun 2026–Dec 2027; BDT 2,20,40,834
C-RANGPUR	Climate resilience and poverty upliftment in Rangpur (see Sec. 4.1.3)	RDRS MEL Department; baseline Sept 2026 schedule

Microfinance (since 1991, now 29 districts, collateral-free loans plus savings/insurance/training, >92% women accounts) and agriculture/climate work (short-duration and flood-tolerant Aman, solar pumps, sack gardening, floating beds, pooled disaster fund for 17,986 households in Kurigram 2023–24) and social work (non-formal schools, health/nutrition, WASH, anti-child-marriage and GBV campaigns) run alongside humanitarian work in Cox's Bazar.

2.7 Microfinance Programme: Udayan, Unnoti and Savings

I am adding this detail because the org-profile reads flat without it. RDRS does not run one generic loan. It runs two main loans with different risk.

Udayan is group-based lending for newly enrolled members. Unnoti is individual lending for members who have moved past group liability. Both sit on compulsory savings. Every member puts in at least BDT 50 a week. The monthly floor is BDT 200 for Udayan and BDT 500 for Unnoti. Compulsory savings carries 6% profit.

On top of that there are two voluntary options. General Voluntary Savings takes deposits up to BDT 10,000 at 7% simple annual interest. The Monthly Savings Deposit Scheme (MSDS) is fixed-term: three years at 7% and five years at 7.5% at maturity.

Two targeted products came up in the policy files I reviewed:

Water Credit is a WASH-linked loan of BDT 10,000–100,000 for safe water and sanitary latrine installation. It runs in 93 branches across six districts: Dinajpur, Nilphamari, Thakurgaon, Panchagarh, Habiganj and Moulvibazar. The loan comes with technical help and hygiene training, not cash alone.

The Livelihood Restoration Loan (LRL), 2nd Phase, was a COVID-19 recovery loan of up to BDT 50,000. Terms on file: six-month grace, maximum 24-month tenure, 8% declining-balance service charge, repaid in 18 monthly installments. It targeted low-income households, farmers and micro-entrepreneurs hit by the pandemic who needed to restart an income-generating activity.

Why this matters for MIS: Udayan, Unnoti, Water Credit and LRL do not carry the same risk or the same check. That difference is what the monitoring checklist in Chapter 4 is built around. Figures here are from internal policy documents and my placement notes; I would re-check thresholds against the originals before audit use.

CHAPTER 3

Literature Review

3.1 Management Information Systems

Laudon and Laudon define MIS as the integrated set of people, processes and technology that collects, processes and distributes information for decisions. For NGOs, the point is narrower: can a manager trust the number on the monthly sheet enough to act on it? That depends less on software brand and more on capture discipline, validation, and timeliness.

3.2 Project Monitoring

The OECD-DAC tradition treats monitoring as continuous tracking against indicators, distinct from episodic evaluation. A baseline fixes the pre-intervention reference; DQA checks validity, reliability, timeliness and precision during implementation. FGD/KII cover qualitative change; household surveys cover quantitative coverage.

3.3 MIS in NGO and Development Settings

Studies of MFI and development MIS converge on three lessons I saw at RDRS: (1) person-dependent reporting is a continuity risk — succession to formal systems matters; (2) last-mile capture (register vs. system) is where error enters; (3) monthly, staff-assigned schedules beat ad-hoc requests for completeness. KoBo-type mobile capture plus Excel/Power BI compilation is now the common low-cost stack, with integrated dashboards (e.g. G Banker) for microfinance portfolios (OTR, PAR, outstanding, write-offs).

CHAPTER 4

Analysis and Findings

This is the core chapter. It uses my daily log and the documents above as evidence.

4.1 MIS Tools and Systems Used in Project Monitoring

4.1.1 What the Evaluation Department actually uses

For regular reports MEL uses structured Excel formats and registers during routine visits. For one-off needs it uses KoBo Toolbox on mobile, which allows quick question changes and exports straight to Excel. In office the team compiles in Excel and uses Power BI for some dashboards. MEL outputs then feed into MIS for management decisions. MEL means Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning; Save the Children uses MEAL, where the extra A is Accountability to beneficiaries.

Table 4.1. Tool stack observed

Task	Tool	Why it fits
Routine capture	Excel formats + registers	Stable, auditable
Ad-hoc surveys	KoBo Toolbox (mobile)	Dynamic Qs, Excel export
Compilation	Excel	Branch-level joins
Dashboards	Power BI + G Banker	Visual follow-up

4.1.2 Baseline design learned through ICPS

ICPS is *Strengthening Disability-Inclusive Child Protection Systems to Prevent and Respond to Violence against Children with Disabilities in Selected Communities of Bangladesh.* Donor UNICEF. Period June 2026–December 2027. Budget BDT 2,20,40,834. Components Output 4.2 (social service systems) and Output 4.3 (harmful practices). Baseline was running in September 2026.

UNICEF gave 21 indicators: qualitative via FGD/KII, quantitative via household survey. Baseline means measuring the target group before start against those indicators. ESS is Environmental and Social Safeguard. TOR sets scope and method; the Inception Report confirms method and work plan before fieldwork. MEL maturity — how systematic M&E is — was a new phrase for me: more mature means more regular and evidence-based.

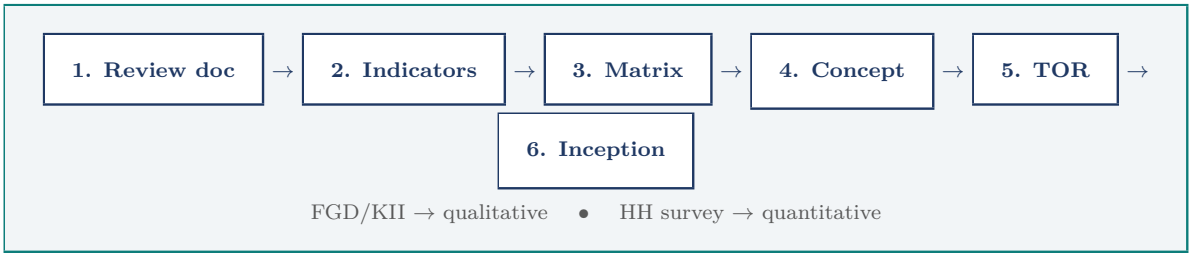


Figure 4.1. Baseline design in six steps as taught by Saiful Alam (ICPS at step 6, Sept 2026).

4.1.3 C-RANGPUR baseline instrument: KoBo questionnaire

The C-RANGPUR baseline household questionnaire is the indicator-measurement instrument for the project. The source document reviewed is the MEL Department file *Baseline_Questionnaires_of_CRANGPUR_-_Indicator_Result_Measerment.docx* (spelling as on file). The live tool is KoBo Toolbox (Enketo Express), hosted as an EU-region KoBo Enterprise instance at `https://ee-eu.kobotoolbox.org/x/wzjSgzZ6`. A plain fetch of that URL returns only the empty Enketo web-form shell; questions, skip logic and dropdown choice lists load dynamically at runtime, so live content including any Division/District/Upazila/Union lists requires opening the form in a browser with appropriate access. The interview opens as a baseline survey under the C-RANGPUR Project, described as voluntary, roughly 30–40 minutes, confidential and unpaid, with a Yes/No consent checkbox before proceeding.

The instrument comprises ten sections. Sections 5–9 map directly onto indicators 1.1–3.2; Sections 1–4 provide location, respondent and household controls; Section 10 is the scored vulnerability module.

4.1.4 Indicator definitions and measurement formulas

Indicator numerators, denominators and formulas are reproduced exactly as specified in the source. All percentage indicators follow the form (Numerator ÷ Denominator) × 100.

Claims in Section 7 carry five sub-measures as specified: claims submitted is the count answering "Yes" to submitting a claim; claims responded to is the count answering "Yes" to receiving a response; claims resolved is the count answering "fully" or "partially resolved"; response rate is (claims responded to ÷ total submitted) × 100; resolution rate is (claims resolved ÷ total submitted) × 100.

4.1.5 Household Climate Vulnerability Index (HCVI)

The Household Climate Vulnerability Index is the composite outcome measure built from Section 10 of the questionnaire (16 scored items across three domains). Its core logic is:

$$\text{Vulnerability} = \text{Exposure} + \text{Sensitivity} - \text{Adaptive Capacity} \tag{4.1}$$

The weighted scoring formula, with weights 30/30/40 exactly as specified, is:

$$\text{HCVI} = (\text{EI} \times 0.30) + (\text{SI} \times 0.30) + [(100 - \text{ACI}) \times 0.40] \tag{4.2}$$

where the three sub-indices are normalised as:

$$\text{EI} = (\text{Raw Exposure Score} \div 20) \times 100 \tag{4.3}$$

$$\text{SI} = (\text{Raw Sensitivity Score} \div 20) \times 100 \tag{4.4}$$

$$\text{ACI} = (\text{Raw Adaptive Capacity Score} \div 24) \times 100 \tag{4.5}$$

Domain A (Exposure, Q10.1–10.5, maximum 20) scores: (1) number of climate-related hazards affecting the HH in the last 3 years (0–4); (2) number of times the HH was affected by any climate hazard (0–4); (3) number of months per year typically affected (0–4); (4) number of temporary relocations/evacuations (0–4); (5) number of times hazards disrupted

Table 4.2. C-RANGPUR baseline questionnaire: section structure

#	Section	Coverage	Linked indicator(s)
1	Background Information (Location)	District, Upazila, Union/Pouroshava, Ward No., Village; location type multi-select: Peri-Urban, Char, Riverbank erosion-prone, Flood-prone, Waterlogging-prone, Drought-prone, Other	—
2	Respondent Identification	Name, sex, NID, age, mobile, ethnicity, religion, marital status, education, occupation, disability status/type, relationship to HH head, prior RDRS involvement (Federation / Microfinance Group / Development Projects)	—
3	Household Composition	HH head demographics; counts of children under 5, lactating mothers, pregnant women, elderly 60+, persons with disability	—
4	Assets, Infrastructure & Land Ownership	Dwelling ownership, homestead land, construction materials, electricity source, drinking water source, toilet facility, livestock/productive assets (14 categories), cultivated land by tenure type	Supports 1.2
5	Household Livelihoods & Income	Income sources (repeat group; 15-category livelihood code), IGA support received, CSA awareness/adoption/support (18 CSA practice types), income trend vs. 3 years ago	1.1, 1.2
6	Community Participation & Decision-Making	Membership across 21 community-institution types, meeting attendance frequency, voice/opinion expression, leadership roles, barriers to participation	2.1 (+ women variant)
7	Access to Social Ser-	14-category safety-net receipt, claims	2.2

Table 4.3. C-RANGPUR indicator definitions and measurement

Indicato	Definition	Numerator / Denominator	Formula
1.1	Targeted climate-affected HHs adopting ≥1 additional income-generating activity, +25% from baseline	Num: HHs with ≥1 additional IGA / Den: total targeted HHs surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
1.2	≥40% of targeted HHs increased income by 20% via Climate Smart Agriculture (CSA)	Num: HHs adopting ≥1 project-promoted CSA practice / Den: total targeted farming HHs surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
2.1	Disadvantaged people's active participation in community decision-making, +30% from baseline	Num: disadvantaged respondents who are institution members, attended meetings, expressed opinions, AND had opinions considered / Den: total disadvantaged respondents surveyed	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
2.1 (women)	Women actively participating in decision-making	Num: women meeting the above criteria / Den: total women respondents	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
2.2	Claims successfully taken up/responded to by local authorities	Num: claims fully or partially resolved / Den: total claims submitted in reference period	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
3.1	25% of disadvantaged community members accessing primary health care	Num: respondents who sought care at CC / UH&FWC / UHC / FWV / CHCP / Den: respondents reporting a health care need in last 12 months	(Num ÷ Den) × 100
3.2	Reduction in NCD prevalence by 25% from baseline	Num: adults diagnosed with ≥1 selected NCD (hypertension, diabetes, heart disease, stroke, chronic respiratory disease) / Den: total adults	(Num ÷ Den) × 100

daily life (0–4). Domain B (Sensitivity, Q10.6–10.10, maximum 20) scores: (1) months of food shortage in the last 12 months (0–4); (2) duration of main livelihood disruption during the last disaster (0–4); (3) highest damage to house/crops/livestock/assets (0–4); (4) difficulty obtaining safe drinking water during the last hazard (0–4); (5) number of HH members needing additional support during hazards, covering children under 5, elderly 65+, pregnant/lactating women, persons with disability and chronically ill members (0–4). Domain C (Adaptive Capacity, Q10.11–10.16, maximum 24) scores: (1) frequency of receiving early warning information before a hazard (0–4); (2) number of disaster-preparedness measures adopted (0–4); (3) adoption of ≥1 CSA practice in the last 12 months (No = 0 / Yes = 4); (4) started or expanded ≥1 IGA to reduce climate risk (No = 0 / Yes = 4); (5) active participation in community institutions (0–4); (6) received preventive health services or adopted health practices for climate-related health risk (No = 0 / Yes = 4).

Table 4.4. HCVI interpretation bands (as specified)

Score range	EI (Exposure)	SI (Sensitivity)	ACI (Adaptive Capacity)	HCVI (Vulnerability)
0–<20	Very Low Exposure	Very Low Sensitivity	Very Low Adaptive Capacity	Very Low Vulnerability
20–<40	Low Exposure	Low Sensitivity	Low Adaptive Capacity	Low Vulnerability
40–<60	Moderate Exposure	Moderate Sensitivity	Moderate Adaptive Capacity	Moderate Vulnerability
60–<80	High Exposure	High Sensitivity	High Adaptive Capacity	High Vulnerability
80–100	Very High Exposure	Very High Sensitivity	Very High Adaptive Capacity	Very High Vulnerability

The full narrative interpretation text for each band is held in Section 10 of the source questionnaire and can be pulled verbatim for an appendix if required. Conceptually, Exposure and Sensitivity are largely external and structural, outside the direct control of RDRS or the household (a hazard-prone location cannot simply be changed), while Adaptive Capacity represents resilience: the dimension programming can influence and where project interventions concentrate. The framework was described in interview as interna-

tionally recognised rather than RDRS-original, consistent with the questionnaire's own reference list: IPCC (2022) *Climate Change 2022: Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability*; Hahn, Riederer and Foster (2009), the Livelihood Vulnerability Index, *Global Environmental Change*; FAO (2016), Resilience Index Measurement and Analysis II (RIMA-II); UNDP (2010), *Designing Climate Change Adaptation Initiatives: A UNDP Toolkit for Practitioners*; Brooks, Adger and Kelly (2005), *Global Environmental Change*; Sullivan and Meigh (2005), Climate Vulnerability Index, *Water Science and Technology*. Calculation is not fully automated in one tool; it runs across a combination of KoBo, Excel and Power BI, with the exact division of labour between them not fully specified (see Appendix verification notes).

4.1.6 MEL matrix and C-RANGPUR data pipeline

The MEL matrix is the monitoring planning tool. The file observed is *F01-112 Enclosure application monitoring matrix_E1_C-RANGPUR* (Excel/WPS), tab "Monitoring Planning". Each indicator carries the standard fields: indicator(s), indicator definition, data needed (quantitative plus qualitative plus disaggregation plus frequency), baseline value, location/source of information, methods/tools for data collection, and when to collect data. An earlier design-meeting note additionally referenced start date, end date and numerator as matrix fields, consistent with that structure.

Table 4.5 shows the worked example for Indicator 1.1 as it appears in the matrix.

The matrix as observed lists both "every six months" and "annually" for the same indicator. Whether this reflects a data-collection versus reporting-frequency distinction or a drafting inconsistency is pending clarification and is not stated as a finding.

The internal planning notes behind this design are undated (the date field on the page was left blank) for a MEL matrix design session noted as "Climate Project → C-RANGPUR". Sampling appears as a discussion heading with no captured detail. Baseline questionnaire design considerations recorded are the type of data needed and target benchmarks (for example "increase one activity by 25%", matching Indicator 1.1). The Monitoring Officer role is recorded as responsible for data validation and field-level data collection. Persons with disabilities are flagged as needing a more deliberate, efficient data-collection approach;

Table 4.5. MEL matrix worked example: Indicator 1.1

Field	Content
Indicator	Targeted climate-affected households adopting ≥1 additional IGA, +25% from baseline
Data needed (quant.)	Household ID; baseline and current IGAs; activity type; start date; income earned per activity
Data needed (qual.)	Reasons for adopting/not adopting; experience, challenges, learning, perceived benefits
Disaggregation	Sex and age of HH head, disability status, location, education level, vulnerability category
Location/source	Household
Method/tool	Structured questionnaire; Interview
Frequency (data-needed field)	Baseline, every six months, and annually (as written; clarification pending, see below)
When to collect (separate field)	Annually (end of each project year)

the exact method proposed is not fully legible in the notes. Data collection methods referenced are FGD and KII alongside the structured household questionnaire.

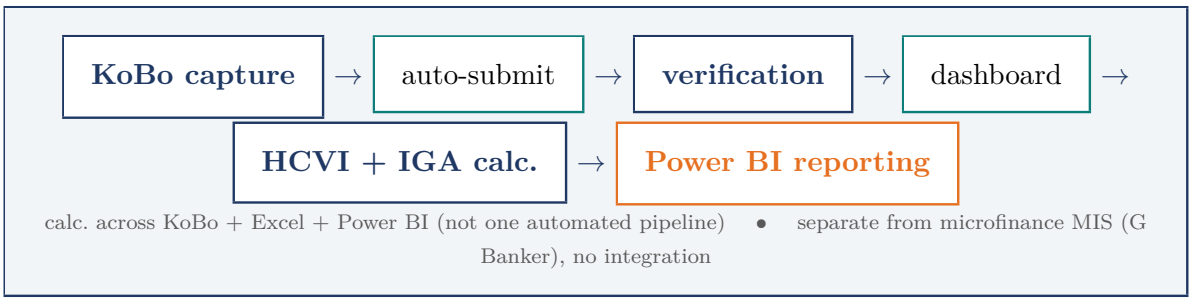


Figure 4.2. C-RANGPUR MIS pipeline as described in the MEL key informant interview.

The pipeline in Figure 4.2 comes from the key informant interview with Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL). Table 4.6 summarises the five MIS questions and answers obtained.

4.1.7 How microfinance MIS changed: Micro Bank to South Tech to G Banker

Mr. Iftekharul Islam traced this from 1995–97, when microfinance was starting and the field role was called ATM (Assistant Thana Manager). First software was Micro Bank, built with support from FAO and GTZ from Germany.[1] A team of 27 developers worked on it, including my grandfather (Boro Abbu) with a colleague noted as Mahabub. After that my grandfather ran most MIS reporting on Micro Bank himself, and RDRS leaned on him too much. One person holding that much reporting knowledge is risky for an organization that size. In 2011 RDRS brought in South Tech to reduce that dependence; my grandfather helped set it up, then retired. Around 2017–18 RDRS moved to G Banker, a Bangladeshi product — the current system with an integrated dashboard where routine branch reports come out with one click.

I saw three outputs from G Banker. The Micro Finance Program Changes Report (CO-wise, Udayan office example) shows month-to-month change by CO: CO count, samity count, member balance, savings, loanee numbers, overdue, outstanding, OTR and PAR, profit/loss, disbursement and write-offs. POMIS-5 (Statement of Financial Position) is a branch balance sheet, this year vs. last year. POMIS-4 (Statement of Comprehensive

[1] My notes say "ZTZ"; that likely means GTZ.

Table 4.6. Key informant interview: Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL) – MIS answers

#	Question	Answer
1	Is HCVI calculation automatic?	No single automated tool; calculation runs across a combination of KoBo, Excel and Power BI
2	What is the "Code" column for?	Supports SPSS statistical analysis; numeric codes (for example 1 = Male, 2 = Female) are set up for that purpose
3	When a KoBo form is submitted, does data reach the dashboard automatically for verification?	Submission is auto-sent on completion, then passes through a verification step before appearing on the dashboard
4	How is the baseline compared to the end goal?	The baseline sets the reference/minimum value the end-of-project target is measured against; once set, monitoring proceeds against it as routine
5	Is the project MIS setup different from the microfinance MIS?	Confirmed as two separate systems: project M&E MIS (KoBo → HCVI/IGA indicators → Power BI) versus microfinance MIS (G Banker); no data integration between them

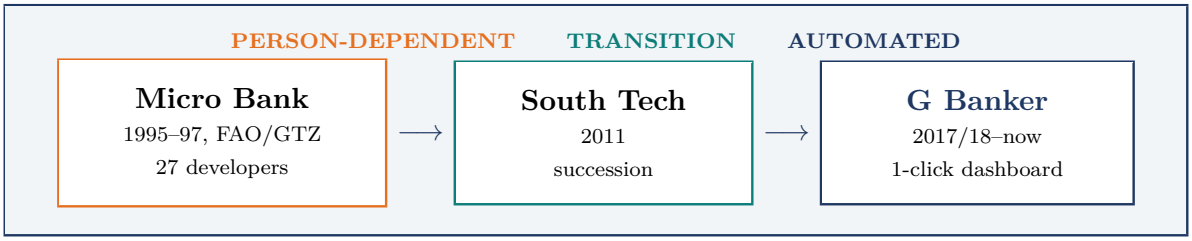


Figure 4.3. Microfinance MIS succession: the continuity lesson of this report.

Income and Expenditure) is a branch income statement, monthly and annual, straight from the system.

4.2 Data Flow: From Field to Decision-Making

MEL staff go to sites, watch activities and collect data, then compile in Excel and Power BI for MIS and management use. The September 2026 monitoring schedule shows how this becomes monthly assignments in two parts.

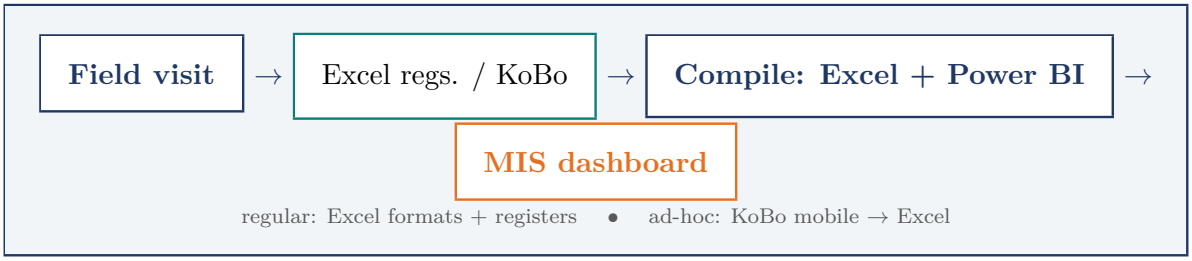


Figure 4.4. MEL to MIS flow as described by Fahmida Mostafa.

Microfinance part: ten repeat tasks, each assigned to one person and one branch, visited twice a month (02–15 and 16–28 Sept): group-level loan/savings verification, staff productivity, savings collection/refunds observation, loan disbursement papers, loan ceilings/overdue follow-up, write-off/rescheduled follow-up, audit/reconciliation, write-off study, misappropriation adjustments, pre-service training assessment.

Development part (that month): C-Rangpur baseline (Rangpur, Lalmonirhat, Kurigram, Sirajganj, Gaibandha, Jamalpur); MCGL DHIS2 validation in Panchagarh; Jononni DQA + ELCO/PW listing in Lalmonirhat/Rangpur; SEEDS economic-inclusion checks in Rangpur; ICPS baseline in Mymensingh/Rajshahi/Rangpur Division 06–24 Sept by Saiful Alam Sekul and Fahmida Mostafa (the live baseline Saiful explained to me); RERP post-distribution follow-up in Cox's Bazar; CALDRI beneficiary checks in Kurigram.

For C-RANGPUR specifically, the field-to-decision path follows KoBo capture with auto-submission, a verification step before dashboard display, HCVI and IGA indicator calculation across KoBo, Excel and Power BI, and Power BI reporting (Figure 4.2). The project M&E MIS is entirely separate from the microfinance MIS (G Banker), with no data integration between them.

4.3 Special Monitoring: What Gets Checked at Field Level

The Evaluation Department does not review portfolios ad-hoc. It works from a set checklist. I copied the headings from internal monitoring notes during placement.

Overdue cases are listed with amount plus a written reason for each. The reason feeds back into the next loan-committee decision. New loans are checked before they enter the normal cycle: what the committee approved against what was actually paid out. Field staff cross-check sanctioned amounts against field records with internal monitoring tools and review the supporting papers.

Loans above a set threshold get tracked on their own against two indicators: Portfolio-at-Risk (PAR) and Overdue-to-Total-Receivables (OTR). Fund misappropriation and forgery cases run on a separate track until resolved. A complaint box at branch feeds into a formal investigation procedure. Above the branch, Regional, District and Area Managers do scheduled site visits as a supervisory layer.

What struck me: the numbers for PAR and OTR come from G Banker, but most of the checks still need a person on site. The system flags. A person verifies. That split — where MIS stops and footwork starts — is where I think the analysis should focus.

4.4 Risk Control Linked to MIS: Credit Shield Insurance

Since July 2024 RDRS has run Credit Shield Insurance with Guardian Life Insurance Limited. Coverage is mandatory and covers two people: the borrower and their nominee. On death the family gets BDT 15,000 in immediate cash help plus a waiver of the outstanding loan (principal and service charge) up to BDT 20 lakh. Premium is BDT 6 per BDT 1,000 disbursed.

The claim path is fixed. The branch hears of a death. The Branch Focal verifies papers and forwards them. The Regional Focal reviews and forwards to the Central Focal at head office. The Central Focal sends verified documents to Guardian Life for decision. The decision comes back down the same chain to the branch, which must settle within five

working days of notification. Timelines on file: branch to report within two working days of confirming death; settled claims paid in monthly cycles; Guardian Life has 10 days to ask for missing documents.

At field level this is still paper and signatures. The software part is compiling and moving what field staff checked by hand. I include it because it shows MIS as carrier, not replacement.

4.5 Compliance Use of MIS: AML/CFT Data

The AML and CFT Policy (effective January 2022) asks for a kept database of everyone who controls or directs RDRS: board of trustees and executive committee members. The fields are fixed: full name, guardian's name, current and permanent address, date of birth, NID copy, TIN, other organizational affiliation, tenure on the board or team, photograph, and anything else the organization asks for. What counts as suspicious or unusual is defined by reference to the Money Laundering Prevention Act 2012 and the Anti-Terrorism (Amendment) Act 2012.

This is not credit monitoring. It is the same database skill used for a different job: reports to Bangladesh Bank and Bangladesh Financial Intelligence Unit. I keep it short because my topic is project monitoring, but it belongs if MIS is read broadly.

4.6 Loan Committee and Approval Hierarchy

Approvals run in tiers. The branch committee clears standard loans. Loans above set thresholds go up to area or regional level. That ladder is the same one monitoring walks back down: who signs off at the top is who checks afterward in field movement and high-value tracking. I note it here to link the product detail in Chapter 2 to the checklist above.

4.7 Strengths of Current MIS Practices

One-click routine reporting from G Banker (CO-wise changes, POMIS-4, POMIS-5) saves branch time. A fixed monthly schedule with named staff, branches and dates makes follow-

up clear. Using Excel for routine work and KoBo Toolbox for ad-hoc collection fits the task: stable formats where possible, flexible mobile forms where questions change. An integrated dashboard pulls data together for decisions.

4.8 Gaps and Challenges Observed

I read the May 2023 monitoring report on the Somriddhi Programme (PKSF) to see MEL output on paper. It covered Vojanpur and Debiduba unions in Panchagarh (since 2014) and Beruabari in Kurigram (since 2018), via questionnaires + FGDs with purposive/random sampling (2 of 3 unions that round) plus document review.

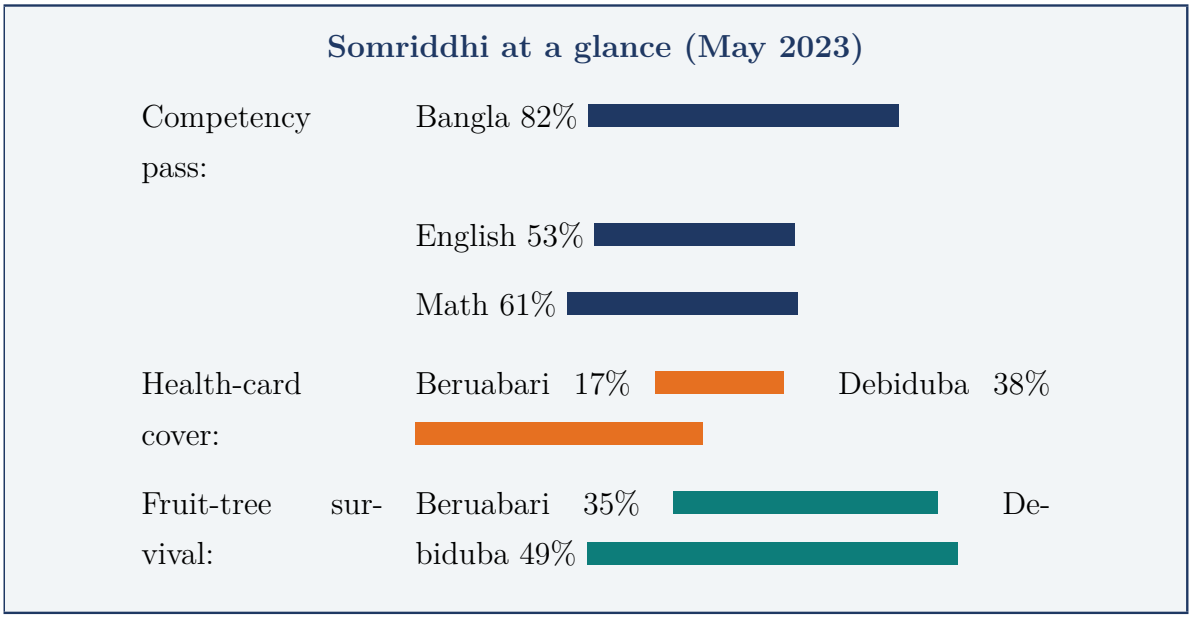


Figure 4.5. Somriddhi gaps as horizontal bars (no extra packages needed).

Education: 74 centres (34 Beruabari, 40 Debiduba; 1,926 students; 12 visited). MIS attendance did not match registers (Beruabari MIS 100% vs. 89% register). Pass: Bangla 82%, English 53%, Math 61%, wide centre variation. Turnover was the main problem: 11 of 74 centres changed teacher in four months; materials short, no play equipment, only 45% followed lesson plans.

Health: card coverage 17% (Beruabari) vs. 38% (Debiduba). Static + twice-weekly satellite clinics plus eye camps. Fees over four months: BDT 47,620 vs. BDT 91,660. FGDs broadly positive; requests: more satellites, lower card cost, steadier medicines.

Rehabilitation (2018–19 cohort, 4 + 8 beneficiaries, ~BDT 1 lakh assets each): Beruabari incomes mostly fell (most >70, no reinvestment route); Debiduba 60% rose. Follow-up patchy — 65% of income/expenditure records missing at visit. Housing (electricity, tube-well, sanitation) improved since baseline.

Homestead (25 + 20 homes; saplings, seeds, compost rings, fencing, poultry/pigeon houses, 2018–19): fruit-tree survival 35% vs. 49% (flood, late planting, weak stock). Vermicompost, eco-stoves, pheromone traps rarely in use.

Cross-cutting issue for my topic: MIS figures and field registers often did not match — the same data-integrity problem as loan-record matching, at programme level.

4.8.1 Instrument and documentation quality: C-RANGPUR observations

Three low-key inconsistencies surfaced in the C-RANGPUR source documents. They do not alter the data but are relevant evidence for an MIS-practices evaluation. First, the sub-heading before the Section 8 (health care) measurement matrix reads "Indicator 3.2 Measurement Matrix" while the matrix itself measures Indicator 3.1 (health care access); Indicator 3.2 (NCD reduction) is correctly introduced separately under Section 9, which points to a labelling slip in the source document rather than a data error. Second, the project name is spelled inconsistently in the codebook ("C RANGPU" at Q5.3.2 versus "C RANGPUR" at Q5.4.1), a minor data-entry and quality-assurance inconsistency. Third, several "select multiple" questions (for example livestock and productive assets, CSA practices, and disability type) appear as single answer-code lists in the Word export; in the live KoBo tool these typically export as one binary (0/1) column per option, so downstream Power BI processing needs to account for that structure correctly.

Implication: add the reconciliation check in Chapter 5 before any dashboard is trusted; include an instrument proofread and a KoBo-export-to-Power-BI mapping check for multi-select fields.

4.9 Sample Findings Table

Field evidence: interviews above; Sept 2026 schedule; G Banker outputs (Udayan, POMIS-5/4); Somriddhi May 2023 report.

Table 4.7. Condensed findings

MIS practice / tool	Observation	Strength / gap
G Banker 1-click	CO-wise, POMIS-4/5	Strength: time, consistency
Monthly schedule	Staff × branch × date	Strength: accountability
Excel + KoBo	Routine vs. ad-hoc	Strength: fit-for-task
Register-to-MIS	100% vs. 89%; 65% missing	Gap: reconciliation
Follow-up	11/74 turnover; 35% vs. 49%	Gap: supervision
Special monitoring	Overdue reason, high-value PAR/OTR, document check	Strength: checklist; Gap: manual load
Credit Shield	Guardian Life since Jul 2024; BDT 6 per 1,000	Strength: clear chain; Gap: paper-heavy
C-RANGPUR KoBo pipeline	Auto-submit → verification → dashboard → Power BI; separate from G Banker	Strength: defined flow; Gap: HCVI calc. across 3 tools
C-RANGPUR instrument	10-section questionnaire; 7 indicators; HCVI 30/30/40; MEL matrix F01-112	Strength: traceable; Gap: label/code slips; freq. to confirm
Udayan/Unnoti + savings	BDT 50/wk; MSDS 3-yr 7%, 5-yr 7.5%	Context for risk

4.10 Daily Log (kept live)

Table 4.8. Daily log excerpt

Date	Activity	Met	Learning
Sept 2026	ICPS walkthrough	Saiful Alam	6 steps; 21 indic.; FGD/KII vs. HH
Sept 2026	MEL workflow	Fahmida Mostafa	Excel/KoBo/Power BI; scale
Sept 2026	MIS history	Iftekharul Islam	Micro Bank → G Banker
Sept 2026	C-RANGPUR KII + instrument review	Md. Ajazul Haque (MEL)	KoBo pipeline; indicators; HCVI; matrix F01-112
May 2023	Somriddhi review	—	MIS-vs-register gap

CHAPTER 5

Recommendations

What follows comes straight from the gaps above. Each item names who does it and when, so it can go into the monthly schedule.

1. **Lock reports only after reconciliation.** Add a register-to-MIS check (attendance, savings, disbursement) to the monthly schedule; the checker signs before upload. Addresses the 100-vs-89 and missing-records gaps.
2. **Single capture in KoBo for ad-hoc work.** Keep Excel as compilation-only so field edits do not fork versions; export to Excel, never re-type.
3. **Protect continuity.** Document G Banker definitions (OTR, PAR, write-off) and keep two trained owners per report family, so no single-person dependency recurs.

If only one is done: do (1). The register-to-MIS sign-off fixes the most repeated error in this report.

CHAPTER 6

Conclusion

The internship showed me MIS as plumbing, not software: Excel, KoBo, Power BI and G Banker matter only because a monthly schedule, a register, and a checker make the number trustworthy.

RDRS has solved the harder half for microfinance through succession to an automated dashboard. The remaining work is the same everywhere — closing the last-mile gap between what the register says and what the system shows. Watching a live baseline (ICPS) and reading a closed monitoring round (Somriddhi) gave me both ends of that chain.

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[1] RDRS Bangladesh, *Annual Report 2021–22*.

[2] RDRS Bangladesh, *Strategic Plan 2023–2027*.

[3] RDRS MEL Department, *Monitoring Schedule, September 2026*.

[4] RDRS, *Field Monitoring Report: Somriddhi Programme, May 2023 (PKSF)*.

[5] RDRS Bangladesh, Microfinance Programme documents: Udayan/Unnoti guidelines, savings (Compulsory, General Voluntary, MSDS), Water Credit and LRL 2nd Phase notes (internal, reviewed during placement).

[6] RDRS Bangladesh and Guardian Life Insurance Ltd., *Credit Shield Insurance policy notes, in effect since July 2024* (internal).

[7] RDRS Bangladesh, *AML and CFT Policy, effective January 2022* (internal).

[8] K. Laudon and J. Laudon, *Management Information Systems*, Pearson.

[9] OECD-DAC, *Glossary of Key Terms in Evaluation*.

[10] RDRS Bangladesh, MEL Department, *Baseline Questionnaires of C-RANGPUR: Indicator Result Measurement* (KoBo Toolbox instrument; Enketo Express instance), reviewed during placement.

[11] RDRS Bangladesh, *F01-112 Enclosure application monitoring matrix_E1_C-RANGPUR*, "Monitoring Planning" tab (Excel/WPS), reviewed during placement.

[12] Md. Ajazul Haque, Manager (MEL), RDRS Bangladesh, Key Informant Interview on C-RANGPUR MIS, indicator and HCVI measurement (date to confirm; contact held on file).

APPENDIX A

Appendix

A.1 Interview guide (used)

Who reports what, when, on which form/app; who verifies; where stored; what breaks most often; what changed with G Banker/KoBo.

A.2 Glossary

MEL, MEAL, ESS, TOR, FGD, KII, HH Survey, IGA, KoBo Toolbox, PKSF, MFI, ATM, CO, OTR, PAR, DQA — as listed in the abbreviations box.

A.3 Next step

Field visit including an eye clinic to observe MEL data collection as direct observation.

A.4 C-RANGPUR sources and verification notes

Sources used for Sections 4.1.3–4.1.6: the MEL baseline questionnaire file, the F01-112 monitoring matrix ("Monitoring Planning" tab), undated internal planning-meeting notes, and the KII with Md. Ajazul Haque. The following items are pending verification and are not stated as findings in the chapters above:

1. Confirm Division/District/Upazila/Union coverage figures against proposal/logframe, matrix location fields, live KoBo choice lists, or GIS/MEAL staff.

2. Clarify 6-month versus annual frequency for Indicator 1.1 (collection versus reporting, or drafting inconsistency).
3. Confirm meanings of the "Monitoring vs. Supervision" and "PO → legal document → advocacy" meeting notes.
4. Confirm purpose of the blank "Code" column across questionnaire tables (working theory: office-side coding of "Other, specify" responses).
5. Confirm exact division of labour between KoBo, Excel and Power BI in the HCVI pipeline.
6. Follow up two unasked KII questions: whether the MEL matrix and live dataset synchronise automatically or need manual reconciliation, and whether/how indicators are selected or reused across reporting cycles.
7. Reconcile the planning-meeting "District → 6 total" note against coverage figures.

Candidate questions held for a follow-up conversation (with MEL/GIS staff) include: who designed the HCVI 30/30/40 weighting; whether the questionnaire is authored in the KoBo form builder or drafted in Word/Excel first; how skip patterns are implemented; whether a real-time submission-progress dashboard exists; how data quality is checked (validation rules, GPS/audio audits, back-checks, duplicate detection); who uses baseline results beyond donor reporting; whether midline/endline reuse the same households or a fresh sample; whether the F01-112 coding is used consistently; how mid-project matrix revisions reach the live KoBo form; and whether the required disaggregation is maintained in practice or simplified for reporting.